

Open Knowledge Format (OKF): The Plain English Guide

How to teach your AI agent the exact rules of your company so it stops guessing.

1. The Real Problem: The AI Doesn't Know Your Rules

When you build an AI agent for your company, it will often get basic facts wrong. For example, if you ask it for the "Weekly Active Users," it might guess the wrong database table. Why? Because the AI doesn't magically know that your specific company excludes test accounts from that metric.

Normally, engineers spend weeks building complex, custom databases just to feed these rules to the AI. This is a huge waste of time. The **Open Knowledge Format (OKF)** is a simple, free way to write down your company's rules so *any* AI can read them perfectly.

2. The Simple AI Dictionary

- **Open Knowledge Format (OKF):** A simple way to organize your company's facts using basic text files instead of expensive databases.
- **Context Assembly:** The difficult job of gathering all the correct background info and giving it to the AI before it tries to answer a question.
- **RAG (Retrieval-Augmented Generation):** When an AI searches through your files (like old emails or PDFs) to find an answer.

3. How It Works: Keep It Simple

OKF doesn't require new software. An OKF "bundle" is literally just a folder full of text files (Markdown files). Each file explains exactly one thing, like a single metric or a single API rule.

Here is what an OKF file looks like:

```
---  
type: Metric  
title: Weekly Active Users  
---  
  
# Weekly Active Users  
  
Counted from the sessions table.  
Test accounts are always excluded.
```

The top part (between the dashes) tells the AI what kind of file it is. The bottom part explains the rule in plain English. That's it. You can write it in Notepad in two minutes.

4. OKF vs. RAG: What's the Difference?

If you already know about RAG, you might think they are the same thing. They aren't. They are teammates.

- **RAG is the Search Engine:** It's the tool that digs through thousands of messy, unstructured documents to find an answer.
- **OKF is the Rulebook:** It is a clean, organized folder of perfect facts.

The winning strategy: Instead of telling your RAG search engine to dig through messy, outdated company Wiki pages, point it directly at your clean OKF folder. The AI gets perfect facts every time.

5. How it Looks in Python (The Logic)

Because OKF is just a folder of text files, you don't need fancy code to use it. You just write a simple script to read the files and hand them to the AI.

```

import os
from pathlib import Path

def get_company_rules(folder_path):
    # Find all the text files in the folder
    files = Path(folder_path).rglob("*.md")

    # Stick them all together into one big text block
    all_rules = ""
    for f in files:
        all_rules += f.read_text() + "\n\n"

    return all_rules

# 1. Grab all your company rules
company_context = get_company_rules("./okf_folder")

# 2. Give the rules to the AI before asking the question
prompt = f'''
You are a helpful assistant. Use ONLY the rules below to answer.

{company_context}

Question: How do we calculate Weekly Active Users?
'''

```

6. When to Use It (And When to Skip It)

Use OKF When:

- You want your AI to stop guessing database names or company metrics.
- You want to write your rules down once, and let three different AI models (like Gemini, ChatGPT, and Claude) all read the same files.

Skip OKF When:

- Your data changes every single second (like live stock prices). Text files can't update fast enough for that.
- You are just building a fun weekend chatbot that doesn't need to know strict company rules.